

T. NAGAR

Saidapet » West Mambalam » Vadapalani » Porur » Kattupakkam » Irungattukottai » Nungambakkam » Manapakkam » Ashok Nagar » Valasaravakkam
Gerugambakkam » Mangadu » Choolaimedu » Egmore » K K Nagar » Kodambakkam » Virugambakkam » Somangalam » Poonamalee » Chetpet



COMFORT WHEELS

Kilpauk resident P.R.M.M. Shanthakumar and his team are called on for assistance during bereavement and health crisis involving celebrities. His vehicle transported director K. Bhagyaraj's body from hospital to home **P6**

Exposed distribution box on busy road in Ramapuram



A high-voltage electricity distribution box on a busy section of Mount Poonamallee Road in Ramapuram poses a threat to road users. The box has been left wide open, exposing a dangerous maze of live wires.

The metal doors are unlatched, leaving the internal electrical components vulnerable to rain and accidental human contact.

The danger extends to the ground as well. Thick power cables can be seen trailing loosely across the muddy curb where pedestrians walk, and motorists negotiate.

With school children, pedestrians, and heavy traffic constantly squeezing past this narrow stretch, a single slip or moment of distraction could prove fatal.

The open electricity junction box on Mount Poonamallee Road in Ramapuram - Nandambakkam.
PHOTO: SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

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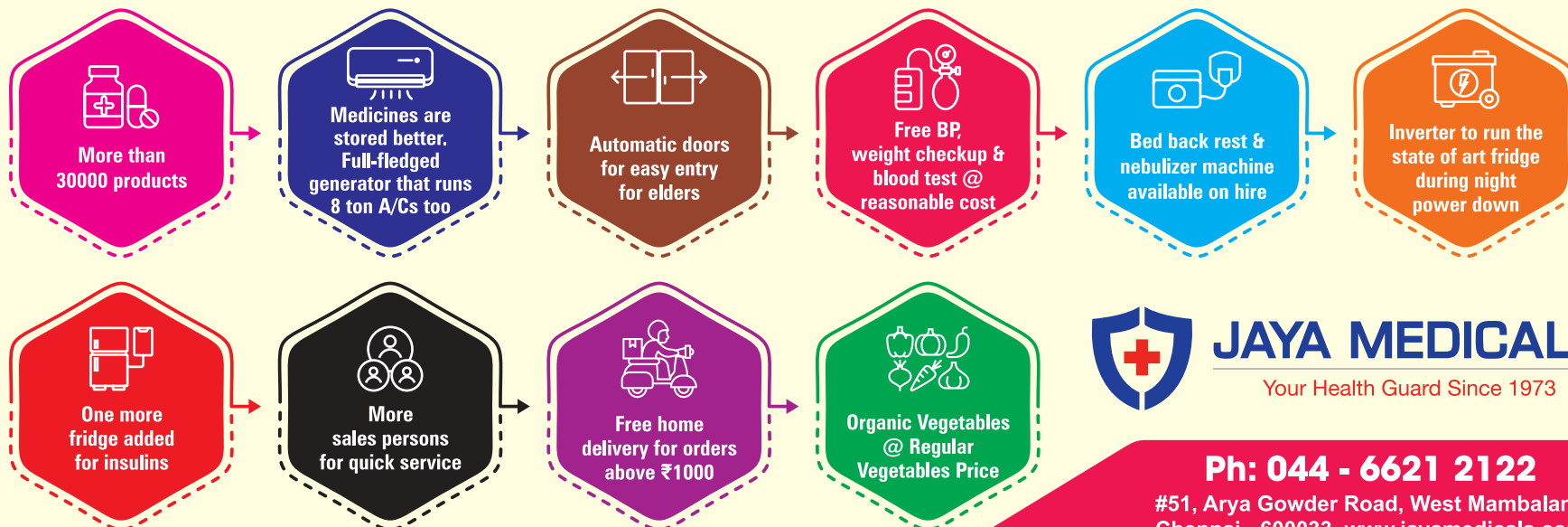


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Runoffs from fish shops leave Ayya Mudali Street **waterlogged**

Many shops on Ayya Mudali Street are switching to the fish trade; the traders sell fish on the street and not inside the shops, which leads to water stagnation

R. RAGU

The fish market at Chintadripet is “scaling” its reach (pun intended). No longer restricted to Arunachlam Street, insulated fish boxes are showing up on Ayya Mudali Street. The shops are changing their trade, the switch to sale of fish being made. In case the reader familiar with Ayya Mudali Street’s long-time dalliance with lace garlands and temple umbrellas thinks shops engaged in trade of these hallowed products are making the switch, the answer is a comforting ‘no’. Notable switches to the fish trade involve a stationery shop, a



Ayya Mudali Street in Chintadripet PHOTO: R. RAGU

hotel and a fast food eatery. These newly established fish shops do not seem to believe in conducting their trade quietly: they make their

presence felt powerfully, so powerful that people have to stop their noses to resisit it.

On account of anonymity, a resi-

dent of Ayya Mudali Street points out that between 3 a.m. and 7 a.m. when the fish trade is at its peak, the sellers place the insulated fish

boxes containing ice blocks and fish crates again packed with ice blocks, out on the roads, and the water from the melting ice flows down the street, carrying with it the stench of fish. Pedestrians cannot walk on the street on account of stagnant water. Even movement of vehicles slows down due to the stagnation. It is a disorderly mess and even till 11 a.m., the smell of fish hangs thick in the air.

The resident says that if these fish sellers keep these boxes inside the shop, nobody could raise an accusatory finger at them, as the water would be flowing inside.

K.A. Muralidharan, president of Chintadripet Welfare Association, underlines the fact this problem affects all residents. Here is what he has to say: “Six months ago, following a complaint by the Association, the fish owners association took action, and fish sellers began to make sure the fish market premises were kept clean. That is appreciable. But the street is not kept clean.”

Greater Chennai Corporation should look into this issue and regulate how these sellers sell their stick.

A ‘pitfall’ in Ramapuram

An open pit with a shutoff valve is found by the side of Sathya Nagar Main Road; it poses a threat to the safety of motorists

PRINCE FREDERICK

An aspect of 360 degree insight is a keen awareness about the impact of one’s actions on others even those that seem distant from one’s domain. That idea is effortlessly infectious, commanding the 100 percent coverage of a nation’s anthem, being on the lips of everyone within its borders. Everyone might pay lip service to 360 degree insight as it is a fashionable, never-jaded, exciting idea; only a few practise it though as it is also an exacting idea. One does not find even a mustard-seed of faith in the heart to believe government civic agencies have this insight. If they do have it, they often do not provide sufficient evidence of it. They provide a mountain of evidence to

the contrary. Here is an addition to that formidable mountain.

As a link route with a chain-link of roads (one eventually connecting Butt Road and Arcot Road) doglegs through Ramapuram, by the side of Sathya Nagar Main Road, a shutoff valve or a waterflow valve (necessary for water supply to be turned on and off) installed by Chennai Metropolitan Water Supply and Sewerage Board (CMWSSB) is lying in wait for motorists. A person acquainted with the space by virtue of his work points out, on condition of anonymity, that on the evening of June 21, when parts of Chennai witnessed a sudden burst of rain, this “trap” successfully ensnared a car, its wheel stuck in the pit. The car was pulled out and sent on its way. But if something has



The pit with the shutoff valve. PHOTO: PRINCE FREDERICK

happened once, it can happen again unless the conditions that trigger it are removed.

The “keeper of valves” has foreseen this possibility, hence two logs placed on the pit where the shutoff valve is ensconced. Those two logs can get dislodged, and even if they do not, at times of poor visibility, such as night time

and when the skies open up with showers, they can be missed along with the pit. A wrong move by a set of wheels is not a matter to be shrugged off. The vehicle that slipped a wheel in happened to have four wheels, and therefore stability was still maintained, and the occupants were safe. What if a wheel that slips in has only one

more for company? If a motorcyclist gets into the pit, they might not get out of it the same; the damage could be costly.

The pit has to have proper masonry work with a sturdy metal grille (one that can be opened to access the shutoff valve) on top of it, sturdy enough to take the load of rolling wheels.



Sterling Road. PHOTOS: SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

‘Driving on Sterling Road is trying’

TINAASHE MATHEW . H

Sterling Road in Nungambakkam is battered and marked with potholes for a considerable period now. This road badly needs a mending exercise. The uneven stretch gives room for waterlogging in case of rains.

The road has become narrow due to metro rail construction and vehicles move slowly. The battered condition of the road adds to the inconvenience and slows down the traffic movement further.

There are schools, colleges, and hospitals in the vicinity and witness heavy traffic. Given its importance, this road should be relaid at the earliest.

Tinaashe Mathew . H is a resident of Choolaimedu

‘Bus shelters at hospital stop in Porur serve no purpose’



GANESH . S

The couple of bus shelters opposite Sri Ramachandra Hospital in Porur on Mount - Poonamallee High Road is in a sorry state. For want of regular maintenance, the shelters are rusted and the roofs are broken. This has been the case for the past many months now.

This stop witnesses a good number of commuters and due to the hospital, a sizeable of them are patients including senior citizens.

Hence, the shelter at this stop ought to be well maintained and convenient.

But on the contrary, these shelters serve no purpose and com-

muters stand exposed to the elements. It is quite difficult during rainy days. Further, the area around the bus shelter witnesses waterlogging.

Factoring in the number of commuters this stop witnesses and the presence of the hospital, the existing number of shelters are not adequate. Therefore, commuters wait on the main thoroughfare which is a State Highway and therefore witnesses heavy traffic. They are at the risk of being hit by vehicles.

Buses toward Iyyappanthangal and Poonamallee halt at this stop.

Metropolitan Transport Corporation and Greater Chennai Corporation are requested to look into this issue.



The bus stop in Porur. PHOTOS: SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

Ganesh S is a resident of Iyyappanthangal

‘Oil Mill Road junction is battered’

P. SENTHIL KUMAR

Stormwater drain construction got completed at the intersection of Oil Mill Road and Mount - Poonamallee High Road in Iyyappanthangal three months ago. But the work has not been restored to this day. The road is battered and gives room for waterlogging in case of rains. Motorcyclists need to exercise extreme caution. The authorities should restore the road at the earliest.

P. Senthil Kumar is a resident of Iyyappanthangal



The junction of Oil Mill Road and Mount - Poonamallee High Road in Iyyappanthangal on June 24, 2026. PHOTO: SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

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The legacy bearers

As India observes National Reading Month from June 19 to July 18, a peek into two popular used-books shops in Chennai that survive because the women running them want to preserve what has been bequeathed to them, despite daunting odds

LAKSHMY HARIKRISHNAN

R.K. Alwar did not want his books to be interred with his bones; and that was his final wish, not expressed on his deathbed but when he realised he was doddering towards it. Alwar's daughters Ammu and Julie have honoured that wish against daunting odds, ensuring the iconic Alwar Book Shop stays rooted to the spot where it has always stood at Luz Church Road in Mylapore. Alwar passed on in 2018 and since then his daughters have witnessed a parade of reasons to go back on their promise. If they had, nobody could have faulted them for it. The pandemic tested their resolve and the ongoing Metro Rail work has done the same thing. But these events had only ended up playing the devil's advocate, revealing to the world that this resolve comes with a cladding of steel.

Around Luz Corner and on this section of Luz Church Road, multiple retail businesses have trotted away in disappointment, but the duo has held on bound by that promise. Metro Rail construction has made Alwar Book Shop difficult to access, barricades and route diversions have discouraged many regulars from visiting it, and the once bustling pavement book shop is marked by a con-



(Above) Alwar's four daughters (from left) Eliza, Ammu, Julie and Lucy at Alwar Book Shop; and Alwar with his family.

spicuous lull. And changing reading habits induced by digital technology is queering the pitch further. But get this right, the daughters bear Alwar's legacy (which is their mother Ma-

ry's too; she also passed on in 2018) not as a burden, but as believers in it. There are believers from outside the family too. For them, Alwar's affable nature makes it compelling to believe

in his legacy and dream, which began in 1939. Ammu points out there are still a good number of customers best described as "loyal patrons"; they continue visiting the book shop because of their affection for Alwar.

The sisters take turns to look after the book shop both living just a stone's throw away from it for easy accessibility and for the unstated reason of refreshing memories. Family time has been around this shop. After marriage, Mary joined Alwar in managing the shop. Ammu recalls her maternal grandmother worked as a nanny at Good Shepherd Convent and, as a child her mother often accompanied her to the school, gradually acquiring English language with its myriad nuances. Though neither of their parents had extensive formal education, their love for literature was immense. "Our mother spoke English beautifully, and both our parents knew books and authors better than most people I have met," Ammu recalls in a tone betraying boundless admiration.

For their father, the bookstore was never merely a business; it provided him with meaning for existence; it was a dream he gave his youth away for. Ammu remembers how her father never spent a single night away from the shop and would brave torrential downpours to ensure not even a corner of a shop got drenched. She laughs while recalling, "He loved books so much that he would absent-mindedly call almost everything a book, even if it was a piece of cloth."

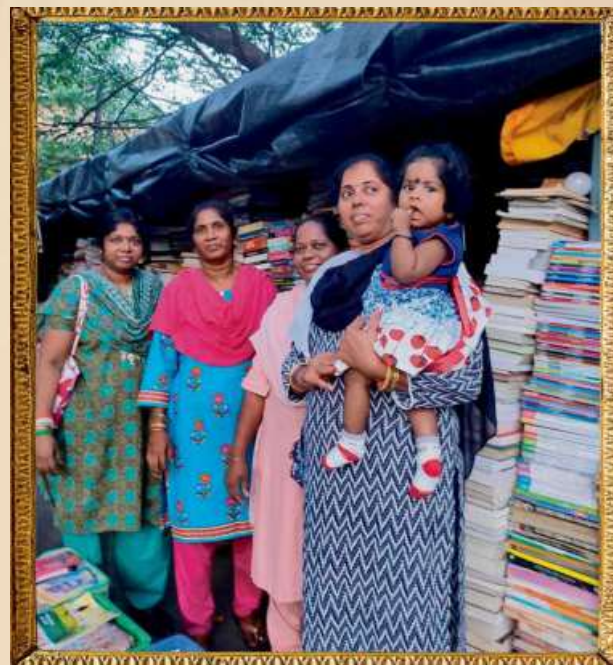
Perhaps the irony is the greatest story at the Alwar Book Shop is not inside any of those

thousands of books lining its shelves, and it is unwritten. This story is lived out every day by two daughters: returning to the same spot, made hallow by his father for those who worship learning and knowledge.

Ammu believes their father has never truly left the bookstore he established at this spot when he was around 16 years old.

Her voice choking and tears in her eyes, Ammu adds, "My dad is still here. We know he is. That is why we will never give up on this shop, even on our hardest days."

Alwar Book Shop, open from 10 a.m. to 7:30 p.m., offering fiction, non-fiction and academic books can be contacted at 9884773591



Scrap dealers probably do not warm up to old books with the same intensity as before; but surprises do crop up

The neighbourhood Kabadiwala as the bookseller

LAKSHMY HARIKRISHNAN

Before the digital revolution, "waste paper mart" was a handy hanger for synecdoche the literary device. Old newspapers and books were always the unlikely bully in a scrap shop, elbowing even heavy metal scrap to the sidelines. In a bloodless synecdochic takeover, these fragile items proudly represented the whole of scrap materials. And the neighbourhood Kabadiwala invariably appended "waste paper mart" to their shop's name. Rajalakshmi Waste Paper Mart on East Coast Road (ECR) in Pallavakkam established 26 years ago mirrors this practice.

Its owner T. Ponraja is winding up operations at Pallavakkam, the shutters to be downed for the final time sometime next week, when he would be launching into his second innings at a new address in Injambakkam on ECR, carrying over lessons and scrap items, not all of them, certainly not the used books and stacks of old newspapers. He notes he is going to the next level, and reveals there is no room for old newspapers and books up there. "I will focus on wooden and metal scrap."

Even at Pallavakkam, the old newspapers and books were not raking in the shekels; a whole truckload of other scraps did that for Ponraja. But he would



T. Ponraja has lost faith in sale of old books as a revenue stream; and (below) Abdur Rasheed believes a demand for them continues to exist.



still display old books he received, on a metal rack right next to where he would be seated. He would not sell those books by a standard weight math, but by deliberate pricing of each individual book, turning over to see the price on the cover. He wanted book lovers to purchase from him. Over the years as smartphone models became thinner, the stacks of books coming in became correspondingly lighter. Good used

book titles were slow in making it to the shelf and slower still leaving it. He has spread out the last stack of books on the shelf. And these books might be waiting for readers that will probably never arrive. No problem with the quality of the collection; only that their time under the sun is up. "Even if I sell a book worth ₹499 for ₹100, there are no buyers," says Ponraja, believing the downward slide began during the pandemic, and is speeding as dependence on technology for information deepens by the minute. "There was a time when he would have a steady stream of customers looking for old books. Their enthusiasm motivated me to collect more books. Now, I have lost my motivation." This is a recurrent theme across neighbourhood scrap shops, many of them not drawn anymore to keeping old books for sale. And that contrasts sharply with how in the past neighbourhood Kabadiwa-

las headlined the chapter on old books in the circular economy. They would welcome old books jettisoned out of households. Sellers of old books would buy from them on the cheap, usually by weight; sometimes residents would be buyers, in which case, the price would be higher but still strikingly affordable. These books would find a cosy shelf in a new home and then again be offloaded onto a tricycle to be carted to a Kabadiwala shop.

While a majority of Kabadiwalas believe the death knell for the used books trade is progressively getting louder, do not be surprised to meet some who continue to believe in it. Abdur Rasheed runs a scrap shop at East Abhiramapuram First Street in Mylapore where a notable display is a wall-mounted metal shelf which is always populated by used books that are sold by weight, a fixed ₹80 per kg. Books might contribute to a negligible part of his income, but he still buys them as scrap, displays them prominently for sale. Explains Abdur: "There is still demand for books; there are still customers coming for books, because of which I go and fetch books. It is an amalgamation of fresh and old books, often both in good condition."

In this National Reading Month, such stories are a sliver of hope for lovers of printed books.

The bookmark shifted from a page of grief to one of growth

On Mount Road, Siva Book House tells a similar tale of loss, memory and resilience. Founded and nurtured by brothers Siva and Sundaramurthy in 1977, the bookstore located in a shopping complex on Blackers Road off Mount Road is now run by Sundaramurthy's wife, Malliga with the assistance of their son Maheshwaran. For nearly six years, the mother-son duo has kept the shelves occupied, refusing to let the bookstore become a forgotten chapter. A homemaker for most of her life, Malliga never once imagined she would one day run the very store she used to visit only to bring lunch for her husband, whom she fondly calls "my sir". It was Maheshwaran, their younger son who insisted the shop should not end with his father's passing and patiently taught her the

nuances of bookselling. She now travels across Chennai using various modes of public transport to collect books as per the trends; a routine once unknown to her now defines her life.

The store, open from 10:30 a.m. to 8:00 p.m., has a range that extends from magazines and fiction to non-fiction and academic books. Siva Book House was a prominent presence on the pavement on Mount Road just a dozen footsteps away from the Anna Salai Post Office. Overtaken by various changes that unfolded on that section, including the razing of a shopping complex, Siva Book House moved "indoors" into this shopping complex on Blackers Road. With reduced visibility, the bookstore thrives largely on the patronage of old customers.

"If someone urgently needs a book,

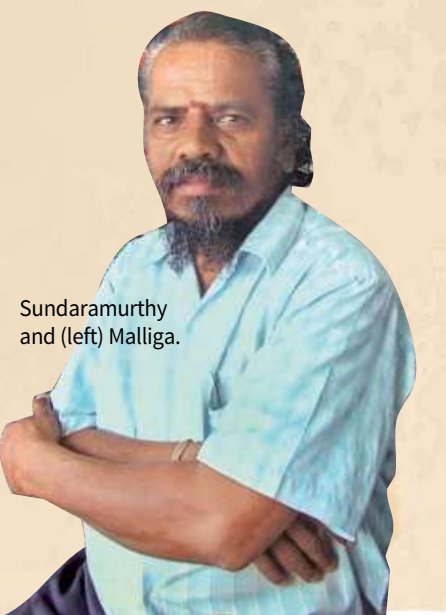
I will come as early as nine in the morning," Malliga smiles.

She fondly remembers how her husband handpicked every collection and occasionally took a young Maheshwaran along, unknowingly nurturing his love for books. Books entered Malliga's world through her husband's voice rather than the printed page. "My sir would narrate stories to me because I was not comfortable with reading any language," she recalls. "I may not have read them all, but I still remember every story he told." Though sales has declined with the rise of digital reading, Malliga believes technology can never replace the joy of walking into a bookstore, breathing in the scent of paper, and finding solace among the shelves. Their regular customers include teachers, government employees and media professionals.

Long after all the books on its shelves have been read, Siva Book House will have a story to be read, outside those book covers: the story of a

woman who stepped outside the confines of her home, picked up her husband's unfinished chapter and found the courage to keep writing it.

Siva Book House can be contacted at 9952934175.



Sundaramurthy and (left) Malliga.

Comfort wheels

R. RAGU

One can pass up an occasion for banqueting, but not an opportunity to be of help to someone facing bereavement or is up against a health crisis, their own or a family member's. In bereavement and health crisis that draw the attention of the wider world because of the personalities involved, P.R.M.M. Shanthakumar has made his presence felt from time to time. His company, Flying Squad Ambulance Service, which offers emergency medical, mortuary and funeral services through its fleet of vehicles, some of them massively high-end, has been called on for assistance during loss and suffering involving big names.

Shanthakumar points out that director the body of K. Bhagyaraj was transported in his company's vehicle from the Apollo Hospital to the deceased director's home in Nungambakkam.

Shanthakumar underlines that his hearse vehicles had been pressed into service for three chief ministers of Tamil Nadu, carrying their mortal bodies; they are V. R. Nedunchezhiyan (who was briefly acting CM in 1969 and again in 1987), J. Jayalithaa and 'Kalaigarnar' M. Karunanidhi.

Shanthakumar explains that in recent times he is also focussed on providing a plush space for people to carry out rituals for their dear deceased. Based on a public-private partnership (PPP), in which he has tied up with Greater Chennai Corporation (GCC), he is offering a cosy air-conditioned space for the performance of rituals and funeral service at the Jones Road burial ground in Saidapet.

A GCC official familiar with the development says a 1,200 sq.ft space was extended to him for the purpose. Shanthakumar notes the built-up area of the facility measures 2,400 sq.ft. The facility is not far from completion, and its inauguration would be announced in the near future, according to the source.

Shanthakumar has already

Kilpauk resident P.R.M.M. Shanthakumar and his team are called on for assistance during bereavement and health crisis involving celebrities. His vehicle transported director K. Bhagyaraj's body from hospital to home. In collaboration with GCC, he will be starting a funeral services facility at the Jones Road burial ground in Saidapet soon



A 5G ambulance; a funeral services facility at New Avadi Road and an upcoming one at Jones Road. PHOTOS: RAGU R. & SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT.



established a similar funeral services facility at the burial ground on New Avadi Road. These facilities being established in collaboration with Greater Chennai Corporation are headlined "Dignified Farewell".

Sixty-five-year-old Shanthakumar, a resident of Kilpauk Garden Colony in Kilpauk, reveals that became aware of the lack of ambulances and hearses when he had a ringside view of how a day goes at an auto stand outside Kilpauk medical college hospital. His father was an auto driver attached to the stand, and a young Shanthakumar, in his teens then, noticed how bodies were being transported in autos for want of hearse services.

Shanthakumar lists among his company's achievements the introduction of a women-led ambulance service, private mortuary, funeral services and pet funeral services. He draws attention to "two state-of-the-art '5G Super Smart Ambulances', equipped with the latest life-saving technologies; each machine fitted with air suspension systems, ensuring maximum comfort and stability for critically ill patients during transport." The services are offered across India, he notes. Other highlights of the services include eight paramedical Professionals, three on-call doctors to accompany patients during critical intercity and interstate transfers; and 120 staff members tasked with patient care, mortuary management and funeral support services.



Students encouraged to become ambassadors of 'Say No to Drugs'



Students of Ethiraj College for Women at the awareness campaign. PHOTO: RAGU R

Ethiraj College for Women observed International Day Against Drug Abuse and Illicit Trafficking with a massive human chain formation on Ethiraj Salai.

Close to 3,000 students participated in the awareness initiative, which was organised by the Anti Drug Club in association with the Red Ribbon Club, Rotaract Club, National Cadet Corps, National Service Scheme, Youth Red Cross, Citizen Consumer Society and Ethish-

akthi.

Holding placards carrying the message "Join Hands and Change Lives", the students raising slogans along Ethiraj Salai, which caught the public eye with their campaign against the menace of drug abuse and illicit trafficking, said a release. The programme was flagged off by V.M.Muralidharan, chairman, who expressed the institute's support to the Government of Tamil Nadu's anti drug initiatives aimed at build-

ing a healthier and safer society.

S. Uma Gowrie, principal and secretary, emphasised that awareness among young people is the strongest weapon against substance abuse. She encouraged students to become ambassadors of the "Say No to Drugs" movement.

The programme concluded with a renewed pledge by the students and faculty to promote healthy lifestyles, social responsibility, and a drug-free future.

World music day celebrated at PSBB Nungambakkam

The courtyard of PSBB Nungambakkam reverberated with mesmerising tunes as World Music Day was celebrated on the morning of June 25.

Students, teachers and parents witnessed the programme, which was graced by the presences of Dean & Director and correspondent of the PSBB Group of Schools, Sheela Rajendra, principal S. Vasanthi and the chief guest, Sangita Kalanidhi recipient R. K. Shriramkumar, renowned musician and PSBB alumnus.

The celebration began with a prayer, followed by a presentation on the history of music and the swaras from the music secretary.

Students presented their renditions of classical music, a fusion band performance and compositions of the chief guest himself.

Finally, R. K. Shriramkumar addressed the students, answered questions about his life and accomplishments and encouraged them to pursue their passions and do what they truly love and enjoy.

The programme concluded with a special performance by the chief guest along with the school's music students.

The principal appreciated the performances and Sheela Rajendra spoke to the students about the calming influence of music and its ability to soothe the mind and reduce stress.

She urged students to learn to appreciate and enjoy music. The celebration was a beautiful and memorable tribute to music and its power to inspire creativity and discipline and connect people across many generations.



During the event. PHOTO: SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

Bengalis honoured for their contribution



Members from various cultural associations were honoured at the Lok Bhavan on June 21 as part of the Foundation Day celebrations of Telangana and West Bengal states.

South Madras Cultural Association and the Bengal Association President Prodyot Bowmick and secretary Sandip Dey of South Madras Cultural Association felicitated the Governor. Abhijit Bose, a member of South Madras Cultural Association and executive president and COO at Tagros Chemicals Pvt Ltd, was conferred with an

achievement award by the Governor for excellence in his field of work, said a release. Kids choir gave a musical performance.

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Building dreams

GRT Jewellers' scholarship programme to support 1,000 students this academic year

When Darshini first came across information about GRT Jewellers' scholarship programme on WhatsApp, she almost dismissed it as spam.

Recently, the B.Com student stood among hundreds of recipients at GRT Mahalakshmi Vidyalaya in Tiruttani, receiving support she believes will bring her a step closer to her academic goals.

For students gathered on the sprawling campus, the Endowment Scholarship ceremony was about more than financial assis-

stance. For many, it was a reminder that educational aspirations need not be limited by financial circumstances.

As part of its Corporate Social Responsibility, GRT Jewellers distributed scholarships to students in the first phase of its 2026-27 scholarship programme. Nearly 1,000 students, including both existing and new beneficiaries, are expected to receive support this year.

G.R. Radhakrishnan, managing director of GRT Jewellers, said the initiative reflects the company's long-standing commitment to edu-

cational empowerment. He noted that the programme aims to recognise academic excellence while encouraging students to dream bigger and achieve greater heights despite financial challenges.

The initiative was launched in 2021 and has steadily expanded in scale and reach.

While scholarships remain at its core, the programme increasingly focuses on students from government schools, those from economically disadvantaged families, and other underserved communities.

The initiative now includes mentorship and academic guidance to help students navigate educational and career decisions.

GRT is considering constructing a women's hostel to provide safe, affordable accommodation for women pursuing higher education away from home, the release added.

ZIMSON celebrates Father's Day with collectors



Zimson, a leading multi-brand watch retailer, recently hosted 'Legacy of Time - A Father's Day Watch Collectors Meet' at V R Mall.

The event was jointly conducted by Zimson, VR Mall, Chennai, and Chronoholic India, an independent watch-collectors' community, bringing together enthusiasts, collectors, and luxury lifestyle patrons for an evening dedicated to horology.

Participants explored timepieces from Rado, Longines, Tissot, and Zimson, while exchanging stories, discussing collecting journeys, and discovering the craftsmanship behind renowned Swiss watch brands.

One of the highlights of the evening was an interactive

watch quiz hosted by Karan Madan, founder of Chronoholic India, where participants were tested on their knowledge of watchmaking history, iconic timepieces, and horological innovations.

Karan Madan said, "Watch collecting is about preserving stories, heritage, and craftsmanship. Events like these provide enthusiasts with an opportunity to learn from one another, discover exceptional timepieces, and inspire the next generation of collectors."

An interactive and insightful session with the audience featured engaging conversations about watch-buying journeys, ownership experiences, antique mechanical clocks, and pocket watch collections, said the press release.

Surya Namaskaram performed



Students from kindergarten to Class 12 took part in the International Yoga Day celebration at PSBB Nungambakkam. According to a press release, students from T. Nagar campus also take part in it.

The chief guest, V.M. Janakiraman, in his address, highlighted the significance of Yoga in boosting physical and mental health. On the occasion, students practised various Yoga poses, including Surya Namaskaram, a sequence of 12 poses.

In her address, S Vasanthi, principal of PSBB Nungambakkam, advised the students to practise Yoga every day.

Yoga Day observed



The 12th International Yoga Day was celebrated by the T Nagar Jeeva Park and Panagal Park Yoga Associations.

Swamini Satyavratana, a disciple of Swami Dayananda Saraswati, was the chief guest.

A set of asanas and pranayama was demonstrated by regular yoga practitioners to the public.

Speaking, Swamini Satyavratana stressed the benefits of yoga and urged the elders to incul-

cate the habit amongst children and youth, instilling discipline from a young age.

The event concluded with Om chanting, prayer, and the national Anthem.

The Jeeva Park Yoga Association has been teaching and practicing yoga for more than two decades under the guidance of experts. The association welcomes the public to learn and practice yoga.

Club marks golden jubilee with new projects



As part of International Yoga Day, Inner Wheel Club of Madras Midtown conducted a yoga session at Thousand Lights High School. The session was conducted by Viji Subramani and Uma Prasad.

Viji Subramani, a member of the club, has been training the students for years by conducting bi-monthly classes. Children look forward to the sessions, and the training has brought about positive change in them, said a release.

On the occasion, books, pens,

and t-shirts were provided to the students by Usha Bothra, president, and Brinda Reddy, member of the club.

This year marks the golden jubilee year of the club. As part of the celebrations, the club has started several sustainable projects. Under 'Nari Shakthi, the Club is providing equipment for women to start their own business, diaper-making machines at Anandham, and distribution of physiotherapy and dialysis machines to organisations, added the release.

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